Shane MacGowan

Kantautor/poet

> (...) a hilariously destructive personality and a master songsmith whose lyrics blended vivid portraits of the underbelly of Irish immigrant life
> – The New York Times

Shane MacGowan ble født i Kent i England i 1957 av irske foreldre. Familien flyttet til Irland da han var 5 år gammel. Han vokste opp i Tallaght, Dublin, og begynte å skrive sanger da han var 12 år gammel. Han ble kjent for sitt rastløse og voldsomme liv, og var kjent for sitt alkoholmisbruk og sine mange fengselsopphold. Han var en av de mest innflytelsesrike og kontroversielle musikerne i Irland på 1980- og 90-tallet, og er fortsatt en av de mest elskede og respekterte artistene i landet.



Shane var punk. Som person og som artist og som forsanger. Det første publikum fikk høre av ham var et grusomt, hes og skrikende forsøk på å synge Frankie Laine-klassikeren «I Believe» på en talentkonkurranse i Dublin i 1976. Han var 18 år gammel, og hadde nettopp blitt utvist fra skolen for å ha kastet en stol i hodet på rektoren. Han hadde allerede begynt å drikke, og det skulle bare bli verre. Mye verre. Han ble kjent for sitt voldsomme temperament, sine mange fengselsopphold og sitt enorme alkoholforbruk. Han var en av de mest kjente og beryktede skikkelsene i den irske musikkscenen på 1980- og 90-tallet, og han var en av de få som virkelig fortjente tittelen «rock'n'roll».



CANNIBALISM AT CLASH GIG

(But why didn't anybody eat MILES?)

Han debuterte tidlig på 1980-tallet i punkbandet The Nipple Erectors, som senere ble kjent som The Nips. Bandet ga ut flere singler og album, og fikk en viss suksess i Irland, men det var først da han startet The Pogues i 1982 at han virkelig fikk gjennomslag. The Pogues kombinerte tradisjonell irsk folkemusikk med punkens energi og attitude, og Shane skrev mange av bandets mest kjente sanger, som «Fairytale of New York», «A Pair of Brown Eyes» og «The Sick Bed of Cúchulainn».



Shane, drikking, kjærlighet og musikk har alltid vært tett sammenvevd. Han har selv sagt at han ikke kunne skrive sanger uten å drikke, og at han ikke kunne drikke uten å skrive sanger. Det er en farlig kombinasjon, og det har ført til mange problemer for ham gjennom årene. Han har slitt med avhengighet til både alkohol og narkotika, og han har vært innom mange rehabiliteringssentre. Han har også vært involvert i flere slagsmål og bråk, og han har tilbrakt mye tid i fengsler og arrester.

> A lot of the Dublin writers miss out on the fact that Shane is a very good writer. He's not just a drunken poet, he's a very good writer. He's got a very good ear for language and for rhythm and for the way words work together. He's got a very good sense of humour. He's got a very good sense of the absurd. He's got a very good sense of the tragic. He's got a very good sense of the comic. He's got a very good sense of the human condition. He's got a very good sense of the world around him. He's got a very good sense of himself. He's got a very good sense of his own mortality. He's got a very good sense of his own failings. He's got a very good sense of his own strengths. He's got a very good sense of his own weaknesses. He's got a very good sense of his own contradictions. He's got a very good sense of his own paradoxes. He's got a very good sense of his own ambiguities. He's got a very good sense of his own complexities. He's got a very good sense of his own simplicities. He's got a very good sense of his own truths. He's got a very good sense of his own lies. He's got a very good sense of his own illusions. He's got a very good sense of his own delusions. He's got a very good sense of his own realities. He's got a very good sense of his own fantasies. He's got a very good sense of his own dreams. He's got a very good sense of his own nightmares. He's got a very good sense of his own hopes. He's got a very good sense of his own fears. He's got a very good sense of his own desires. He's got a very good sense of his own needs. He's got a very good sense of his own wants. He's got a very good sense of his own loves. He's got a very good sense of his own hates. He's got a very good sense of his own passions. He's got a very good sense of his own emotions. He's got a very good sense of his own feelings. He's got a very good sense of his own thoughts. He's got a very good sense of his own ideas. He's got a very good sense of his own beliefs. He's got a very good sense of his own values. He's got a very good sense of his own principles. He's got a very good sense of his own morals. He's got a very good sense of his own ethics. He's got a very good sense of his own conscience. He's got a very good sense of his own soul. He's got a very good sense of his own spirit. He's got a very good sense of his own heart. He's got a very good sense of his own mind. He's got a very good sense of his own body. He's got a very good sense of his own life. He's got a very good sense of his own death.
> – Nick Cave

Shane MacGowan ble kjent for sine politiske meninger og sitt engasjement for irske saker. Han var en sterk tilhenger av Irsk republikanisme og støttet IRA. Han var også en sterk kritiker av britisk imperialisme og av den britiske regjeringens behandling av Irland. Han skrev flere sanger om disse temaene, som «The Broad Majestic Shannon» og «The Old Main Drag».



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> Fairytale of New York
> The Old Main Drag
> The Broad Majestic Shannon
> A Pair of Brown Eyes
> The Sick Bed of Cúchulainn
> The Body of an American
> The Church of the Holy Spook
> The Rare Ould Times
> The Irish Rover
> The Parting Glass
> The Wild Rover
> The Dirty Old Town
> The Auld Triangle
> The Band Played Waltzing Matilda
> The Leaving of Liverpool
> The Black Velvet Band
> The Rocky Road to Dublin



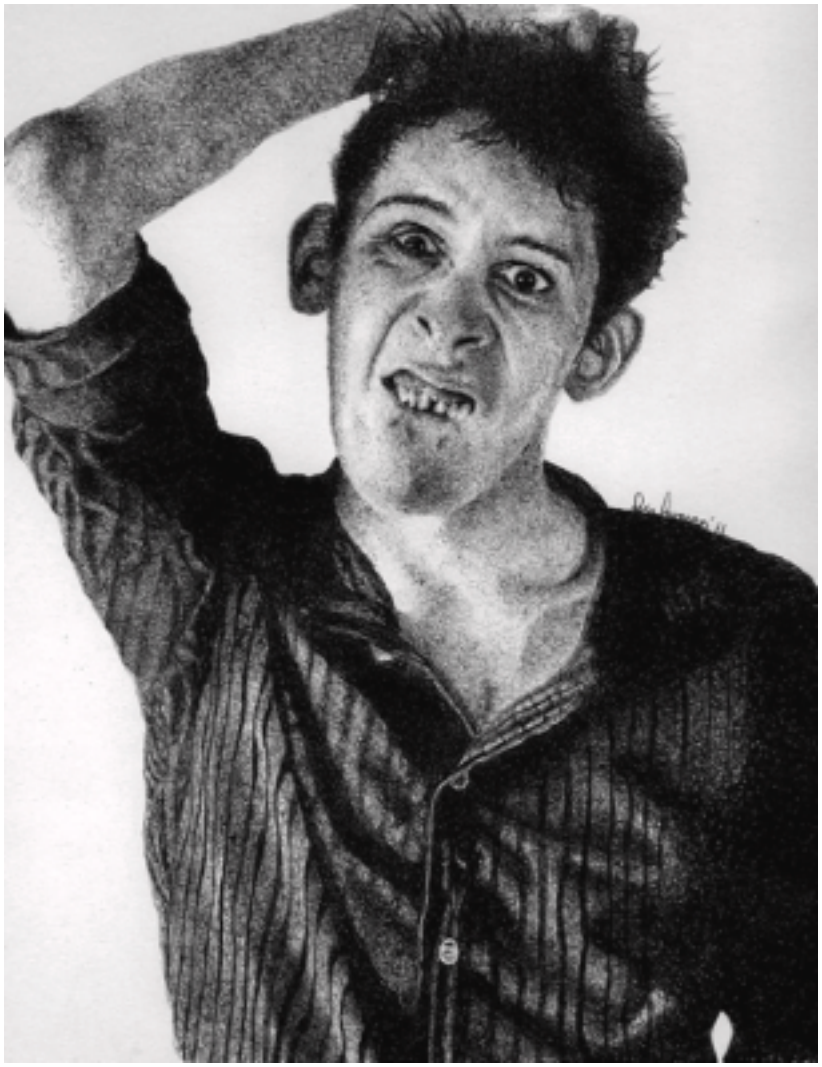
At the time, I was working for a landlord

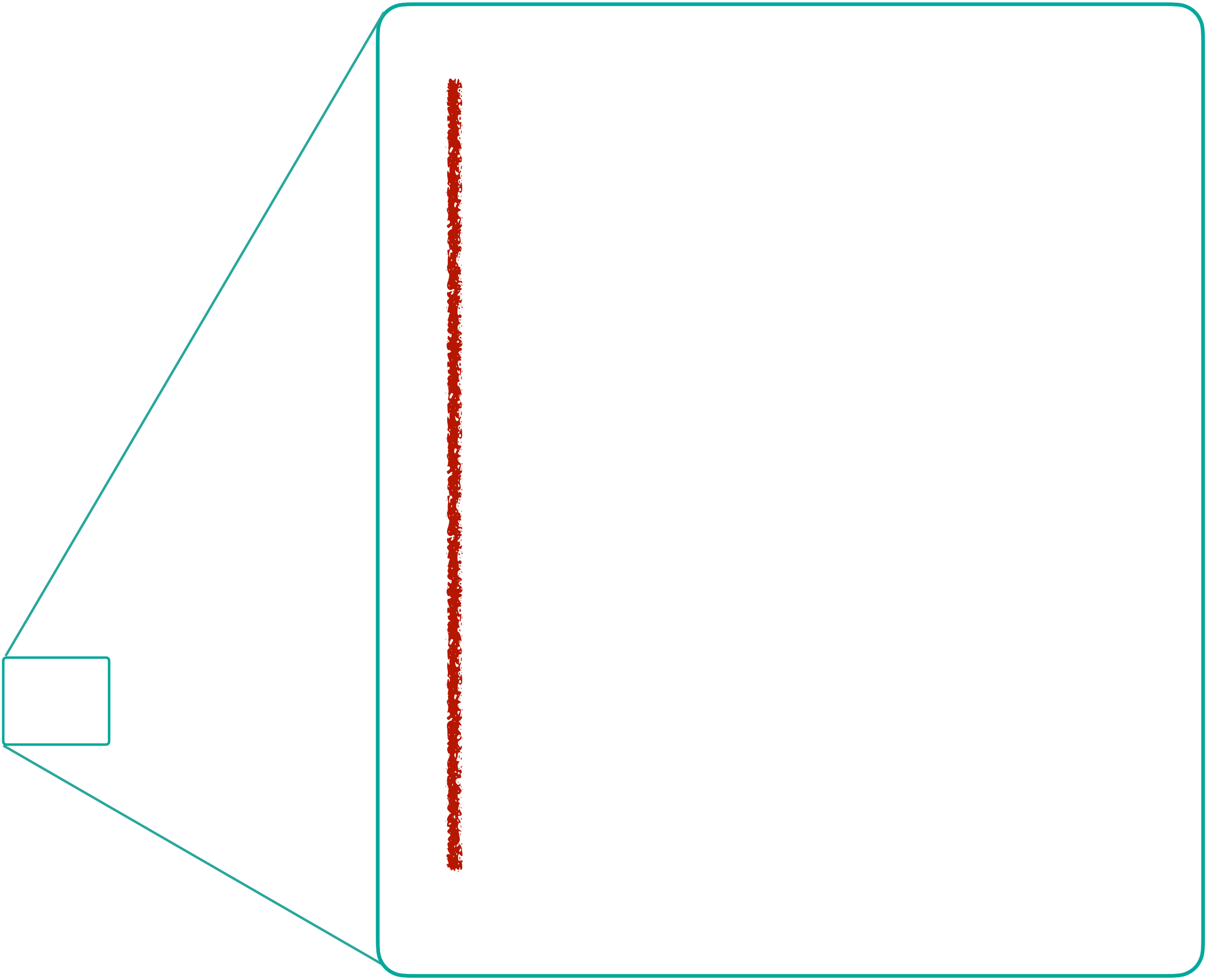
He was the meanest bastard that you have ever seen

To lose a single penny would grieve him awful sore

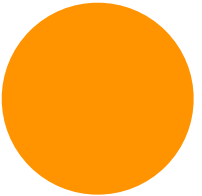
He was a miserable bollocks and a bitch's bastard's whore

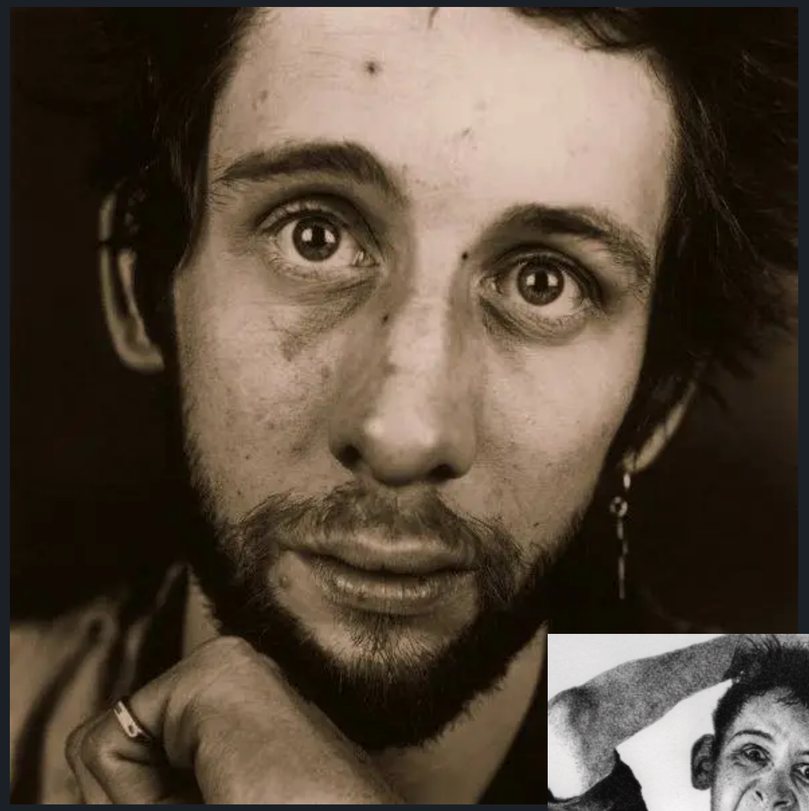


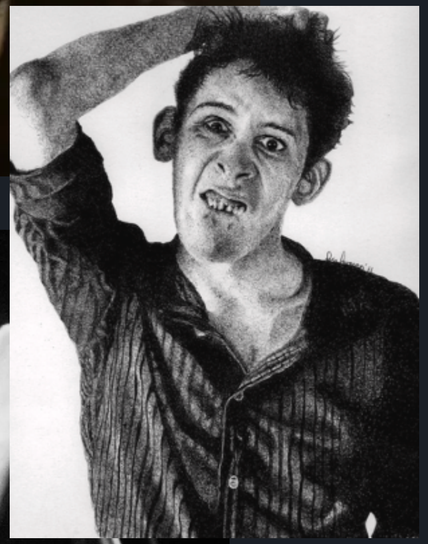




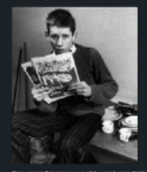
And, it's lend me ten pounds
I'll buy you a drink
And mother
wake me early
in the morning

















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